Return to Your First Love

Revelation 2:1-7 (KJV)

Scripture

Revelation 2:1-7

[1] Unto the angel of the church of Ephesus write; These things saith he that holdeth the seven stars in his right hand, who walketh in the midst of the seven golden candlesticks; [2] I know thy works, and thy labour, and thy patience, and how thou canst not bear them which are evil: and thou hast tried them which say they are apostles, and are not, and hast found them liars: [3] And hast borne, and hast patience, and for my name's sake hast laboured, and hast not fainted. [4] Nevertheless I have somewhat against thee, because thou hast left thy first love. [5] Remember therefore from whence thou art fallen, and repent, and do the first works; or else I will come unto thee quickly, and will remove thy candlestick out of his place, except thou repent. [6] But this thou hast, that thou hatest the deeds of the Nicolaitans, which I also hate. [7] He that hath an ear, let him hear what the Spirit saith unto the churches; To him that overcometh will I give to eat of the tree of life, which is in the midst of the paradise of God.

Outline

1. Jesus knows our works

Jesus said, "I know thy _____."

Nothing done for Jesus goes _____.

Read: Revelation 2:1-3; Hebrews 6:10; 1 Corinthians 15:58

2. Busy, but losing love

Thou hast left thy first _____.

We can keep doing the right things while the heart _____.

Read: Revelation 2:4; Matthew 24:12; Jeremiah 2:2

3. Remember, repent, return

Remember therefore from whence thou art _____, and repent.

Do the _____ works.

Read: Revelation 2:5-7; Hosea 14:1-4; Luke 15:20

Discussion questions

1. What did Jesus commend in the Ephesian church? Why do you think he started there?

2. How can a church or a Christian be doctrinally sound and hard-working but still lose its first love?

3. What were the "first works" in your early Christian life?

4. What practical steps help rekindle love for Christ?

This week

Spend time this week remembering: write down how you came to faith and what Jesus meant to you then. Choose one "first work" to take up again. Pray each day: "Lord, restore my first love."